

Yueh Ya (Sam) Hsu

yuehya@uchicago.edu | (US) +1 (303) 842-8221

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate, *Public Policy, Development Economics*, **University of Chicago** 2024 – present
MPH, *Epidemiology/Biostatistics*, **Washington University in St. Louis** 2020
BS, *Applied Mathematics*, **University of Colorado Boulder**, with honors 2015

EXPERIENCE

PhD Candidate – **University of Chicago**, Chicago, IL Aug 2024 – present

- Completed PhD-level sequences in microeconomics, game theory, and econometrics
- Completed second-year field courses in development
- Overseeing research activities for study assessing microfinance for refugees in Kyegegwa, Uganda

Research Professional – **University of Chicago**, Chicago, IL Aug 2023 – Jul 2024

- Preparing journal article for study assessing impact of work on psychosocial health in refugee community in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh and overseeing policy dissemination with UNHCR, BRAC
- Overseeing research activities for study assessing demand for forecasts and insurance among smallholder farmers in Telegana, India
- Developing partnerships for study assessing microfinance for refugees in Kyegegwa, Uganda

Senior Research Associate – **Harvard Business School**, Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh Jun 2022 – Jul 2023

- Managing research activities for two World Bank projects: 1) evaluation assessing impact of work on psychosocial health and 2) evaluation assessing impact of photography-based intervention intended to develop sense of home for adolescent refugees
- Supervising team of 40+ enumerators, field monitors, and research analysts
- Implementing selection and randomization algorithms; analyzing data in R
- Developed dashboard tools for rapid data monitoring and quality assurance

Consultant – **Refugee Self-Reliance Initiative** Jan 2022 – Jul 2023

- Providing technical support to 10+ refugee NGOs to assess self-reliance by curating datasets and creating dashboards; assessing geographic coverage and progress toward self-reliance markers
- Using R (*tidyverse*, *Shiny*) for data cleaning, analysis, and dashboard creation

Research Associate – **Innovations for Poverty Action**, Dhaka, Bangladesh Nov 2021 – Aug 2022

- Managed research activities for BRAC's evaluation of Ultra-Poor Graduation program, a multifaceted set of interventions designed to address the complexity of extreme poverty
- Oversaw data quality processes: coding questionnaires in SurveyCTO, developing enumerator training, supervising data backchecks, cleaning, and analysis

TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

Relevant Coursework

Math: linear algebra, mathematical statistics, linear models, machine learning, causal inference

Economics: micro theory (PhD-level), econometrics (PhD-level), behavioral economics (PhD-level)

Programming

Advanced: R, Stata, ODK (SurveyCTO, Kobo, etc.)

Working: LaTeX, Python, SQL, PowerShell, GIS

Basic: SAS, MATLAB, SPSS

Languages:

Mandarin Chinese (professional working proficiency)

Bengali (limited working proficiency)

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant – Social Policy Institute, St. Louis, MO

Oct 2018 – May 2020

Student Researcher – Innovations for Poverty Action, Monrovia, Liberia

Jun 2019 – Mar 2020

Data Specialist – Hannover Re, *Denver, CO*

Jul 2016 – Jul 2018

Math Fellow – Denver Public Schools, *Denver, CO*

Nov 2015 – Jun 2016

Research Assistant – University of Colorado Boulder, *Boulder, CO*

REACCTING Group (Emissions, Air Quality, and Cooking Technologies)

Jun 2014 – Oct 2015

Mathematical Biology Group

May 2012 – Dec 2014

WORKING PAPERS

Hsu, Yueh-ya, Reshmaan Hussam, Erin M. Kelley, and Gregory Lane “The Impact of Employment on Partnerships: Evidence from a Refugee Settlement”, BFI Working Paper, 2025 (43), 2025.

AWARDS

COMAP International Mathematical Contest in Modeling

Outstanding (top 11 overall of 5,636 teams), *Mathematical Association of America Award*

Apr 2013

- Researched water resource crisis in Saudi Arabia and developed water management plan